

Getting bigger

Humans grow from birth to their late teens, mainly as a result of cell division. Controlled by the body's growth hormone, cell division increases the number of cells, allowing the body to grow. When growth ceases in adulthood, cell division maintains and repairs body tissues.

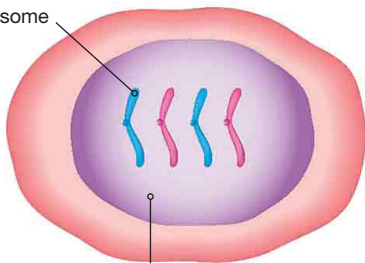


HEALING

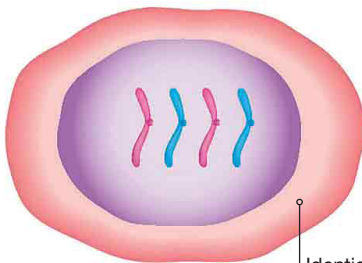


If the skin is cut or grazed, the damage is repaired automatically. Cell division is an important part of this repair process. At the wound site, cells divide to produce new skin cells to replace those that have died or been scraped away. Cell division also plays a key part in repairing damage inside the body.

Chromosome



Nucleus of
offspring cell



Identical
offspring cell

New cells